

Tools — Search

Text and pattern search across files. For code-symbol queries (functions, types, imports) use the Code Intelligence tools instead — the codeindex is faster and returns structured results.

Tool	Description
<code>grep</code>	Search file contents for a regex pattern (ripgrep).

Use cases: finding TODO/FIXME comments, matching text in config files and markdown, locating log fragments.

System instruction: “Use `grep` for arbitrary text and pattern matching. Use codeindex tools for code symbol queries.”

`grep`

Search file contents for a Rust-syntax regex pattern using ripgrep, respecting `.gitignore` rules. Binary files are skipped automatically.

Arguments

Argument	Type	Required	Description	Typical value
<code>pattern</code>	string	yes	Regex pattern (Rust regex syntax)	"TODO", "fn main"
<code>path</code>	string	no	Directory or file to search (default: working directory)	"src"
<code>include</code>	string	no	Glob restricting which files are searched	"*.rs", "**/*.ts"
<code>exclude</code>	string	no	Glob of files/directories to exclude	"vendor/**"
<code>case_insensitive</code>	boolean	no	Case-insensitive matching	false
<code>multiline</code>	boolean	no	~/\$ match line boundaries across lines	false
<code>max_results</code>	integer	no	Maximum matches returned (max 500)	500

Example:

```
grep pattern="TODO" path="src" include="*.rs"
grep pattern="unsafe code" case_insensitive=true
```